

021 Look for space rocks

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MINS

Every day, about 500 tons of rock from space collides with our planet. Most rocks burn up as shooting stars, but tiny particles often float to Earth. Try this experiment and you may find some micrometeorites.

What you need

- Magnet • Paper cup
- String • Sheet of white paper
- Magnifying glass
- Tweezers



1 Tie a loop of string to the cup, as shown. Put a strong magnet inside. Take this outside and tap it gently on dry ground.



2 When black specks show on the cup base, take it indoors. Put it on the white paper. Remove the magnet. Tap the cup to release the specks.

Tiny particles



3 Use a magnifying glass and tweezers to pick out rounded specks. These could be magnetic iron or nickel micrometeorites.

022 Make a Martian landscape

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Put sand in an old baking sheet. Snip steel wool over it. Moisten the sand with salty water and leave for a few days. As the steel wool rusts, the sand turns red, like the soil on Mars.

Martian soil contains a lot of iron

